

CSC425 Deliverable 2: User Research & Problem

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Target User Group

International College Students:

Young international students often face challenges navigating everyday “adulting” tasks in a new country. They may struggle to find reliable information on topics like filing taxes, completing essential paperwork, understanding financial systems, and decoding common acronyms.

Problem Description

International college students often move to the United States without any prior knowledge, or experience, on navigating various adult tasks. Cultural and language barriers often hinder them from being able to easily access resources on how to do their taxes, or file certain paperwork.

Evidence of the Problem

- *“Dad I wish you were here, I’m getting extremely frustrated because I have no idea how to get reliable, cheap car insurance” - phone call from Trinity Noble (this was a real event)*
- *“I’m so glad you’re here to help me, I couldn’t figure out how to do my taxes and couldn’t find any online tutorials for internationals” - an anonymous roommate*
- Compared to their international counterparts, domestic students can quickly adapt to higher education since they usually have a support system. Whereas international students live in a foreign land with different cultures, have little knowledge of the way of life, and barely know people in the new destination ([Shah et al., 2019](#)).

“How Might We” Statement

How might we make international students more familiar to different responsibilities they’re expected to uphold in the USA?

User Persona

Name: Nicole Romero

Age: 19

Occupation: Full time student, part time student worker at Starbucks

Location: Murray, KY

Goals: Completing her bachelor's degree while making income to purchase her groceries.

Frustrations: Limited resources on international students filing taxes, vague questions on government paperwork, she has no one to advise her on how to acquire good insurance.

Technology Comfort Level: Moderate (uses a smartphone daily)

Ethical Lens Applied

Principle: Equity of access to essential life resources and information

- **Application:** International students are at a high disadvantage because they face cultural, linguistic and systemic barriers that limit their access to reliable resources on tax paperwork, insurance, and various government forms. This inequality can negatively affect their financial stability, academic success and overall well-being.
- **Stakeholders Impacted:** International students, universities
- **Professional Standard:** Aligns with ACM Code of Ethics 1.4: *"Be fair and take action not to discriminate."* By providing equitable access to critical information, we ensure that international students are not discriminated against due to their nationality or lack of 'local knowledge'.